

Lab: Formulating a Business Goal with AI Assistance



Estimated Time: 20 minutes

Objectives

- Write effective prompts using best practices
- Begin formulating a business goal with genAI assistance
- Generate context needed to develop business goal metrics

Prerequisites

You should have familiarity with:

- Prompt writing process
- Prompt writing approaches
- Writing effective prompts
- Using a generative AI tool
- Software that records plain text such as Google Docs, Notepad, or Microsoft Word

Introduction

Correctly implementing AI means matching the business problem to the right tool, technique, or solution. In this lab, you will combine what you know about prompt writing and AI integration to formulate a business goal. You will brainstorm using genAI to assist in identifying the context needed to develop appropriate metrics for measuring business goal success.

You will be encouraged to use your own area of business to formulate this business goal. To help illustrate the steps in this process, we will provide you with an example that you can also use to experiment.

Exercise

Step 1. Identify pain points

In this step you think about pain points for your organization that AI could help address.

Consider this example pain point:

- *As the customer service director for an online retailer, my expenses have exceeded my allotted budget for the last three quarters.*

Think of three pain points.

Write down your pain points in a text-based document such as Google Docs, Microsoft Word, Word Pad Notepad, or MS OneNote.

Step 2. Propose changes that might address your pain points

Next, use genAI to help you brainstorm possible changes that may help alleviate your pain points. Prompt the AI to have it help you brainstorm potential changes you could make to address your pain point.

Your prompt should include:

- Persona
- Pain point
- Additional appropriate context
- Clearly stated goal
- Output expectations

Include the following as part of your output expectations:

- Limit the number of suggestions to 5
- Ask the AI to not provide solutions for your pain point. You only want to know what aspects of the business might need changed that could help you address your pain point.

In the generative AI tool, select the GPT-4o model at the top of the window. You do not need to enter any prompt instructions.

Recall the various prompt writing approaches and the elements needed in an effective prompt. Knowing what approach to take and the elements of a good prompt will help you craft a prompt suited to your needs.

- ▶ Hint: Prompt writing approaches
- ▶ Hint: Elements of effective prompts
- ▶ Customer service example prompt

In our example and with the help of our genAI, let's say we decide to use this change for addressing our pain point:

- *Anticipate and address customer issues before they escalate into costly interactions.*

We will discuss methods to evaluate the output to your prompt in another lesson. For now, use your expertise to think critically and reflectively about the output. In short, it should make sense to you.

You should now have a change needed to address your pain point.

Write down at least one change that will help address your pain point in your text document. You will use this as part of your business goal.

Step 3. Think about metrics

Recall that business goals need metrics. A business goal needs metrics to measure success. Metrics require quantitative data to measure your degree of success.

Think about your own answer that pertains to your business goal.

- What would you consider "success" if you instituted your change?
- Do you have data that supports how to measure this change?
- What data do you have access to?

- Do you think your data:
 - Is representative
 - Is relevant
 - Has reliable sources
 - Is of sufficient quantity
 - Is high enough quality

You need to decide what metrics reliably answer that question.

In addition to your own metrics, use genAI to brainstorm other potential helpful metrics.

Avoid the temptation of directly asking for metrics. It doesn't understand your business well enough yet. What you can do, however, is ask what other information it needs to know about your business so it can help you determine appropriate metrics.

Recall in the example we chose this change to address our customer service budget pain point:

- Anticipate and address customer issues before they escalate into costly interactions.

- ▶ Example prompt
- ▶ Sample output from the AI

Prompt the AI to ask it what information does it need to help you identify potential metrics.

Refine your prompt as needed until you get at least two or three responses that make sense to you.

Write these responses in your text document.

In the next lab, you will practice evaluating these responses.

Conclusion

Summary

After completing this lab, you now know:

- To write a prompt that delivers the information you need from your AI model, begin with a clear goal. Avoid ambiguity with your words, provide concise context, and specify expectations for the output.
- When formulating your use case, determine your pain points, propose solutions, and think about the information you need to establish metrics you need to measure success.
- You can use genAI to help you analyze your pain points and identify areas of your business you will need to consider when deciding on metrics that help measure your success.

Next Steps

Use what you've learned to identify a possible use case.

Author(s)

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